herdr on Ctrl–Space

~/.config/herdr/config.toml · herdr 0.8.2 · every binding below is live on this machine

PREFIX `ctrl` + `space` same key as tmux

workspaces → tabs → panes, and a workspace is one repo
panes run fish, not the login zsh
no colours of its own, so ghostty's theme comes through untouched
the sidebar carries branch, git status and every agent's state
drag to select and it copies when you let go

`f` set by your config
`w` stock herdr, still bound
`ctrl` held with the key, no prefix

Tap the prefix, let go, then press the key.
Rows that need no prefix say so.

1 SPACES — *one workspace, one repo*

`f`	project picker: fuzzy-find any git repo under ~/personal or ~/projects, newest commit first, and open a workspace rooted there with `claude agents` running in it *(re-picking a project returns you to it)*
`w`	workspace picker
`shift` + `n`	new workspace
`shift` + `w`	rename this workspace
`shift` + `d`	close this workspace *(asks first)*
`shift` + `g`	new workspace on a fresh git worktree

Next / previous workspace and **prefix+shift+1…9** ship unbound. Set `next_workspace` or `switch_workspace` under `[keys]` if you start keeping more open.

2 TABS — *inside a workspace*

`c`	new tab, *asks for a name first*
`n` `p`	next / previous tab
`1`–`9`	jump to a tab by index
`shift` + `t`	rename this tab
`shift` + `x`	close this tab

3 FROM THE SHELL — *the herdr CLI*

`herdr`	launch, or attach to the session already running
`--skill`	print the agent control guide. Read it before scripting herdr: the binary is the authority
`--default-config`	every setting with its default, commented
`config check`	validate config.toml
`server reload-config`	same as `shift` + `r`, from anywhere
`agent list`	every live agent and its state, as JSON
`pane list`	the pane tree, as JSON
`update`	install the latest build (`channel set preview` *to ride ahead*)

IDs are opaque and never reused: `w1` workspace, `w1:t1` tab, `w1:p1` pane. Read them out of the JSON rather than guessing. Bare `herdr` opens the TUI, so it is no good for probing.

4 PANES — *splits inside a tab*

`v`	split to the right *(not `|` as in tmux, which herdr will not take as a key)*
`-`	split below
`h` `j` `k` `l`	focus left / down / up / right
`tab`	cycle to the next pane
`shift` + `tab`	cycle backwards
`z`	zoom this pane full-screen, again to undo
`x`	close this pane
`shift` + `p`	rename this pane
`b`	collapse the sidebar to its narrow rail, again to bring it back

Stock resize mode is **prefix+r**, which reviewr holds here. Drag a border with the mouse, or give `resize_mode` another key under `[keys]`.

5 MODES & THE REST — *navigate, help, detach*

`g`	navigate mode: jump anywhere without the prefix once you are in. `h` `j` `k` `l` or arrows for panes, `↑` `↓` for workspaces, `1`–`9` for tabs, `esc` to leave
`?`	help: every binding that is live
`s`	settings
`q`	detach, and the server keeps every pane running
`shift` + `r`	reload config.toml in place
`shift` + `o`	go to the pane that raised the last notification *(moved off `o`, which now picks files)*

A reload reaches everything except how a pane is *created*: `default_shell` and `new_cwd` only apply to panes opened afterwards, and `sidebar_start_collapsed` waits for a full relaunch.

6 TOOLS ON A KEY — *all yours, all in config.toml*

`a`	a second claude beside this one. Runs `fish -C claude`, so quitting the agent leaves a shell instead of collapsing the split
`shift` + `a`	the background `claude agents` for this repo, in a popup. The sidebar cannot show them: a dispatched session has no pane of its own
`d`	lazygit, in a popup *(not `g`: that is navigate mode)*
`e`	nvim as a full-height sidebar
`o`	open a file path printed in the agent's output
`r`	reviewr's diff pane, on and off
`t`	your Pythia slurm queue, split to the right over ssh

prefix+e and **prefix+o** come from the herdr-nvim plugin; on the nvim side its own keys hang off `<leader>h`. Add more with `herdr plugin install <user/repo>`.

7 AGENT STATES — *what the sidebar dots mean*

working	busy on your last prompt
blocked	herdr recognised an approval or a question on screen
done	it finished while you were looking elsewhere
idle	ready for input, and you have seen the tab
unknown	an agent is there but herdr cannot classify it; never read this as finished

done and **idle** are the same underlying state; what separates them is whether you have looked. Focusing the tab marks it seen, reading the pane from the CLI does not. Finished and blocked agents also reach macOS notifications, set by `[ui.toast] delivery = "system"`.

Where the stock layout gave way: lazygit left its permanent pane for a popup, because the sidebar already shows branch and status. `o` moved to `shift` + `o` for the file picker; `e` and `r` now carry the nvim sidebar and reviewr rather than scrollback editing and resize mode.